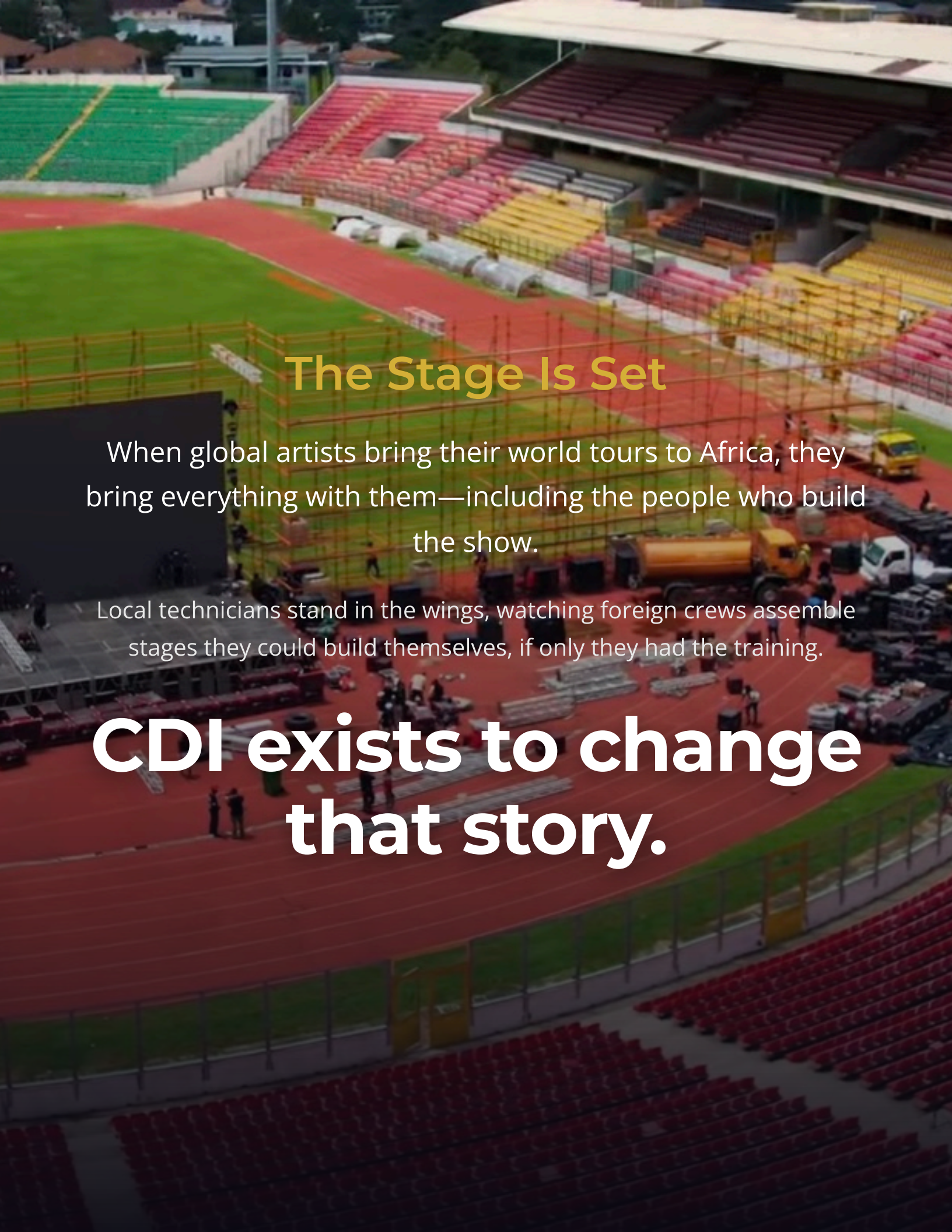
CDI

CREW DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE

Building Africa's Live Entertainment Workforce

Where world-class productions meet local expertise



The Stage Is Set

When global artists bring their world tours to Africa, they bring everything with them—including the people who build the show.

Local technicians stand in the wings, watching foreign crews assemble stages they could build themselves, if only they had the training.

CDI exists to change that story.

A Continent Ready for Change

The African live entertainment industry is exploding. The infrastructure is not keeping pace.

85%

OF AFRICAN LIVE EVENTS RELY ON IMPORTED TECHNICAL CREWS

$5B+

PROJECTED AFRICAN MUSIC INDUSTRY VALUE BY 2026

$2B+

ANNUAL PRODUCTION SPENDING LEAVES THE CONTINENT

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FORMAL PRODUCTION TRAINING PROGRAMS IN MOST WEST AFRICAN MARKETS

The talent is here. The infrastructure is not—yet.

How We Build the Future

CDI operates through three interconnected programs, each designed to create sustainable change:

LEARNING

School-based programs and hands-on training for local technicians. University partnerships across three continents bring academic rigor to real-world skills.

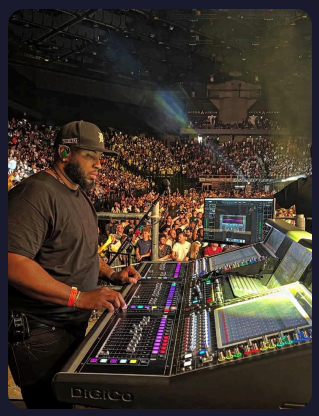
ADVISORY

Industry professionals working alongside local crews on actual productions. Not just teaching—mentoring through live experience.

PRODUCTION

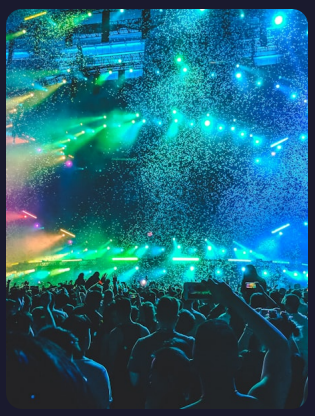
Direct production support during the transition period, gradually stepping back as local teams gain confidence and capability.

The Technical Arts



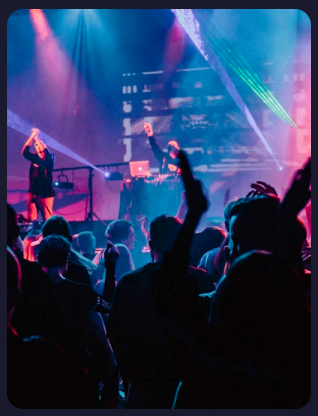
AUDIO

FOH and monitor engineering, system design, RF coordination. The invisible foundation of every performance.



LIGHTING

GrandMA3 programming, rigging, show design. Transforming darkness into visual narrative.



VIDEO

LED wall systems, camera operation, Resolume, content management. The screens that define modern entertainment.

RIGGING

Load calculations, safety protocols, truss systems. Where physics meets precision.

The Work

Real production. Real training. Real results.

Leadership

Erica D. Hayes

FOUNDER & EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Fifteen years across concert touring, television, and film. IATSE Local 728. CBU Professor.

Keith Bernard

LIGHTING DESIGNER & VISUAL DIRECTOR

Career spanning film, television, national events, and concert touring.

Blake Brady

PRODUCER & OPERATIONS LEADER

A decade of technical direction, stage management, and live event production.

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Measuring What Matters

Training Scale

100+ stagehands trained per quarter

60-120 specialist technicians per cohort

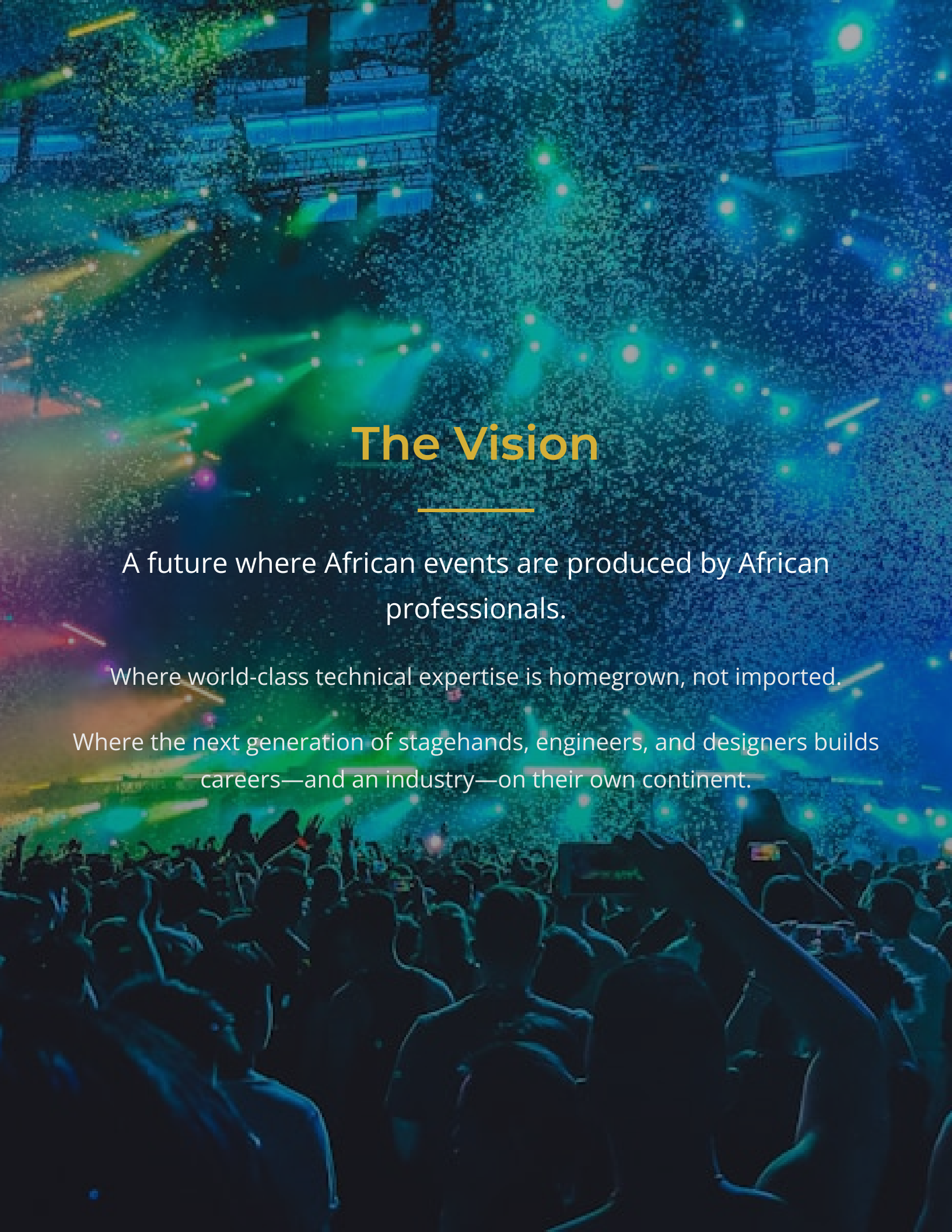
Economic Impact

3-5x wage increase for certified technicians

85% target graduate employment rate

Multiplier Effect

Each trained technician supports **5+** additional jobs and keeps revenue on the continent



The Vision

A future where African events are produced by African professionals.

Where world-class technical expertise is homegrown, not imported.

Where the next generation of stagehands, engineers, and designers builds careers—and an industry—on their own continent.

Partner With Us

Your investment creates lasting infrastructure for Africa's creative economy.

Fund Equipment

State-of-the-art gear that trains the next generation

Support Mentorship

Programs that transfer decades of expertise

Build Facilities

Infrastructure that anchors sustainable programs

Enable Careers

Opportunities that transform communities

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CDI is a registered 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization. All donations are tax-deductible.

The Stage Is Set. Join the Crew.